

Forge Platform ICP #1: Early-Stage Technical Founders

Core hypothesis

Technical founders want to spend time on product differentiation — not rebuilding authentication, deployment pipelines, observability, cloud infrastructure, and operational tooling.

Typical characteristics

- Bootstrapped, pre-seed, seed, or recently funded
- Building software with meaningful operational requirements
- Expect security, deployment automation, observability, and cloud architecture to matter

Common examples

- B2B or AI SaaS
- FinTech or HealthTech
- Developer tools
- Data platforms
- Vertical SaaS
- Consumer applications with meaningful backend complexity
- Custom commerce platforms

Qualification questions

- Are they building a real product — not a demo, agency deliverable, or throwaway MVP?
- Will they need accounts, auth, deployment discipline, and observability within the next 6–12 months?
- Would a platform engineer month (or more) on undifferentiated infrastructure hurt their timeline or runway?

Poor fits

- Agencies or consultancies buying on behalf of clients
- Local businesses or simple brochureware products
- Marketplace MVPs with minimal backend requirements
- Thin AI wrappers with no meaningful platform or operational needs

Buyer titles

Founder, Co-Founder, Technical Founder, Founder & CTO, CTO, Founding Engineer, Lead Engineer, Principal Engineer

Core tech stack

- Java and Quarkus (JVM or GraalVM native) on AWS ECS Fargate
- Cognito, RDS PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, and S3
- Infrastructure defined in CDK; delivery via GitHub Actions
- Prometheus, Grafana, and OpenTelemetry
- Forked to the customer's GitHub org; runs in their AWS account

Timing signals

Recent or planned hiring for backend, platform, DevOps, or infrastructure engineering often indicates the team is about to invest in foundations Forge already provides.

Primary message

Launch with enterprise-grade operational maturity from day one. Focus engineering on domain services and differentiators — not on rebuilding the platform every scaling company eventually needs.

Conversation hooks

"Most teams spend years assembling the operational stack behind a SaaS company. With Forge, a capable engineer can be deploying on a production-ready platform from day one."

"Shortcut your CTO or founding engineer's workload by ~50% — and keep them on product, not plumbing."

"The entire operational stack behind a modern SaaS company — without hiring a platform team first."

"Platform capability normally built by companies 10x your size — available from the start."

"Enterprise-grade foundations at a fraction of the cost of building them yourself."

"Early adopters: free founder-led deployment support."